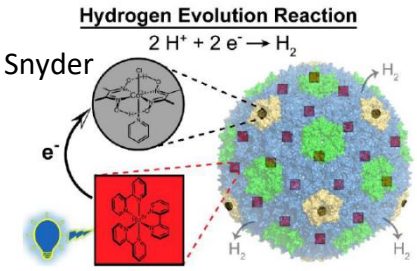
Program and Abstracts

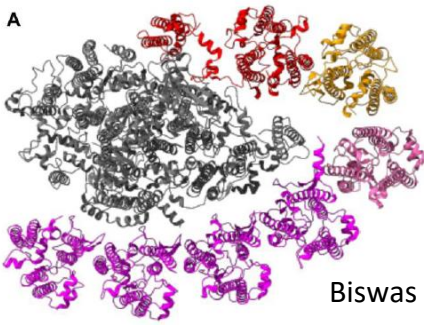
52nd Annual Midwest/Southeast Photosynthesis Conference

Turkey Run State Park
Marshall, Indiana

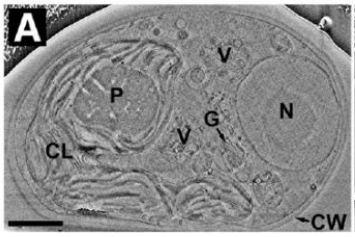
October 23-25, 2026

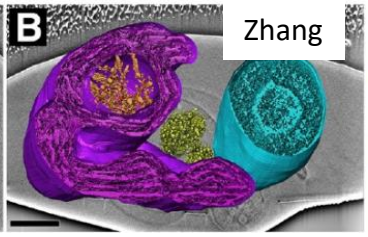


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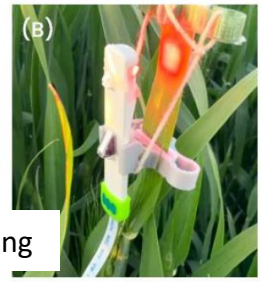
Biswas



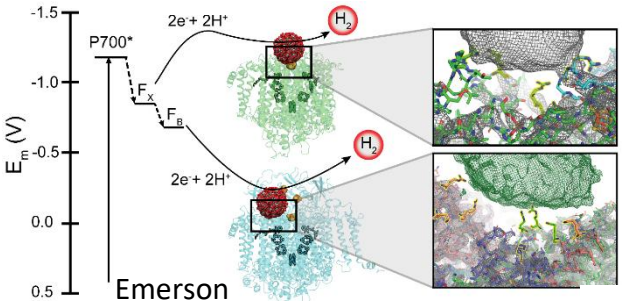


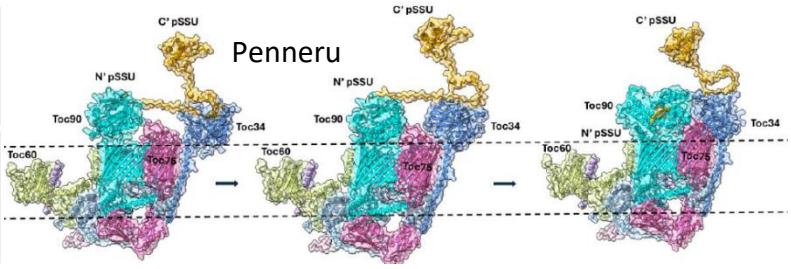
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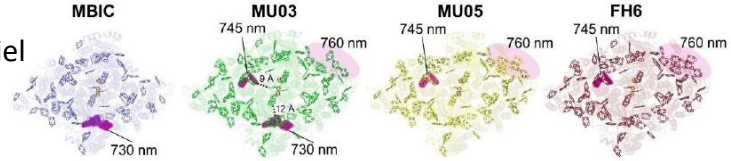


Huang





Penneru



Gisriel

Organizers:

Alizée Malnoë (Chair)
Department of Biology
Indiana University, Bloomington
Bloomington, IN
amalnoe@iu.edu

Colin Gates (Co-Chair)
Department of Chemistry
Loyola University Chicago
Chicago, IL
cgates4@luc.edu

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Thanks to our sponsors!











Program

Friday, October 23

4:00 - 6:00 pm	**Registration & Poster Hanging**
6:00 pm	**Dinner**
7:30 pm	**Introduction and Welcome**
7:40 - 8:20 pm	**Keynote Lecture**: Laurie Leonelli (University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign): *Overlooked in the Understory: Managing Light Responses in the Shade*
8:20 - 8:40 pm	Erika Serravalle (University of Florida): *Substitutions in the pD1 C-terminal extension modulate proteolytic processing and photosynthetic stress tolerance*
8:40 - 9:00 pm	Sree Kavya Penneru (University of Tennessee Knoxville): *Dynamic GTPase Dimerization Coordinates the TOC Translocon*
8:00 - 9:20 pm	Swarnali Mukherjee (Oklahoma State University): *Understanding CO_2 uptake and proton pumping in cyanobacterial Photosynthetic Complex 1*
9:30 pm	**Mixer and Poster Session**

Saturday, October 24

7:00 am	**Breakfast**
9:00 - 9:40 am	**Keynote Lecture**: Kevin Redding (Arizona State University): *Insights into long-range electron transfer from the heliobacterial reaction center*
9:40 - 10:00 am	Christopher Gisriel (University of Wisconsin-Madison): *Multiple Routes to Red-Shifted Chlorophyll* d*-Based Photosynthesis*
10:00 - 10:20 am	Sabiha Tamanna (Georgia State University): *Probing the Reaction Center and Long-Range Electrochromism in Far-Red Photosystem I: A*

Comparative Study of Chroococcidiopsis thermalis *and* Fischerella thermalis

10:20 - 10:40 am **Coffee Break**

10:40 - 11:00 am Hasan Tuncer (Purdue University): *Electronic Structure and Hydrogen-Bond Control of O-O Bond Formation in Photosystem II*

11:00 - 11:20 am Christian Brininger (University of Wisconsin-Madison): *Quantifying Site-Specific Radiation Sensitivities within Photosystem II*

11:20 - 11:40 am Audrey Short (Argonne National Laboratory): *Investigating Fundamental Interactions Involved in Photosystem I-Driven Electron Transport*

11:40 - 12:00 pm Luisa Maria Sandoval Calle (Purdue University): *Constructing accurate Force Fields for (Bacterio)chlorophylls via ab initio calculations*

12:00 - 12:20 pm Christian Durbin (Michigan State University): *State Transitions in the Photoprotective Orange Carotenoid Proteins Probed by Molecular Dynamics Simulations*

12:30 pm **Lunch**

1:30 pm **Group Photo and Hike**

Afternoon Free

4:00 - 6:00 pm **Poster Session**

6:00 pm **Dinner**

7:30 - 7:50 pm Ru Zhang (Donald Danforth Plant Science Center): *Investigating Heat Induced Chloroplast Structural Changes by Multiscale Cryo-Volume Electron Microscopy and Cryo-Electron Tomography in the Green Alga* Chlamydomonas reinhardtii

7:50 - 8:10 pm Mahipal Rao (University of Tennessee Knoxville): *Light-driven Spatiotemporal Thylakoid Membrane Remodeling in Cyanobacterium* Chroococcidiopsis *TS-821*

8:10 - 8:30 pm	Jon Nguyen (Michigan State University): *Simulating Photosystem I-Ferredoxin Binding and Downstream Acceptor Specificity in* Chlamydomonas reinhardtii
8:30 - 8:50 pm	Mitchell Ticoras (Michigan State University): *Probing Photosynthetic Resiliency in Plants With a Metabolically Engineered Shikimate Pathway*
9:00 pm	**Poster Session**

Sunday, October 25

7:00 am	**Breakfast**
9:00 - 9:20 am	Berkley Walker (Michigan State University): *What does photorespiration have to do with photosynthetic energy balancing?*
9:20 - 9:40 am	Maria Santos Merino (Michigan State University): *Phosphorylated sugars as signaling molecules in cyanobacteria*
9:40 - 10:00 am	Maxwell Harman (Michigan State University): *Genetic Dissection of Photosynthetic Oscillations Reveals ATP Synthase's Central Coordination of Carbon/Light Reaction Balance*
10:00 - 10:20 am	Harvey Hou (Alabama State University): *Tri-Institutional (NLR-WashU-ASU) Cyanobacterial CUREs at Alabama State University*
10:20 - 10:40 am	Panel: *AI and its responsible use in the photosynthesis community*
10:40 - 11:00 am	**Coffee Break**
11:00 am	**Awards Presentations**

Abstracts

Oral abstracts are listed first, in chronological order. Poster abstracts are listed alphabetically by the last name of the presenting author.